

C2_08 Gate A - Protected Review RC4

Marketplace Sellers. Normal Gate after SBA1-SBA12 mastery and management-review Mini-Lab; review opens only after a saved genuine Gate A attempt.

Page 1 - Evidence and decision boundary

Area	Evidence / control
Domain	Marketplace Sellers
Non-negotiable	Finance profitability + Trust fraud/refund risk cannot be hidden
Capacity/constraint	Seller Ops can act on 20 sellers/week
Observed evidence	Seller A: GMV 420,000; refund 8%; fraud flag 18%; contribution margin 16%; on-time ship 92% Seller B: 360,000; 3%; 5%; 24%; 88% Seller C: 310,000; 10%; 21%; 13%; 74% Seller D: 280,000; 2%; 4%; 27%; 96% Seller E: 250,000; 4%; 7%; 22%; 90%
Material limitations	Fraud outcome lags transactions by up to 14 days (High) Seller category mix affects return rates (Medium) No controlled evidence that coaching causes GMV improvement (High)

Required output

A management recommendation that separates observation, inference and recommendation; shows stakeholder trade-offs; states uncertainty; gives action/owner/measure/review; and identifies missing evidence/owners rather than inventing facts.

Page 2 - Expected reasoning and diagnostic traps

Expected reasoning
GMV-only ranking would favor A/B/C by volume but would hide material Trust/Finance signals; Trust and profitability are explicit non-negotiables.
Seller C has the highest refund/fraud rates, lowest contribution margin and weakest on-time shipping in this five-seller evidence set; it is a defensible intervention priority, but do not claim a cause without further evidence.
Seller A combines highest GMV with elevated refund/fraud risk and lower margin than B/D/E; volume does not make the risk disappear.
Seller D is strongest on margin, refund/fraud and on-time shipping in this set; low intervention priority is defensible, but "best seller" depends on the defined decision.
Fraud lag means current fraud flags may be incomplete; category mix means return-rate comparisons need segmentation before causal/policy conclusions.
The case contains only five sellers while Ops capacity is 20/week. Do not invent a capacity bottleneck; state whether this sample is complete and ask for the full intervention population if needed.
Because coaching impact is not controlled, recommend an intervention/measurement plan rather than promising GMV uplift.

Critical traps

Trap	Why it blocks
Single-metric ranking	It can hide explicit finance/risk/policy constraints and answer the wrong decision.
Causal language from observational evidence	Association/risk score/operational pattern does not establish intervention effect.
Silent stakeholder compromise	The analyst is not authorized to erase a non-negotiable; expose options and decision owner.
Fake precision	Missing cost, calibration, population or causal evidence must remain uncertainty/open question.
No owner/review rule	A recommendation without accountable action and evidence review is not an executable management decision.

Page 3 - Repair and changed fresh retry

Use this protected review only after a saved genuine Gate attempt. Close it before reassessment.

Step	Required evidence
1. Diagnose	Name the failed competency: discovery, O/I/R, prioritization, uncertainty, conflict, recommendation, defense or handoff.
2. Repair	Correct only the weak reasoning; state why the original wording/decision was unsafe or unsupported.
3. Close review	Do not keep this worked review open during the reassessment.
4. Changed fresh retry	Solve a new management case with different evidence, stakeholder conflict and material limitation. B/C must remain fresh.
5. Save evidence	Save the new O/I/R, options/trade-off, executive summary, recommendation, uncertainty, defense and owner/handoff as a separate attempt.

Pass standard

The learner can defend the new recommendation without the review open, identify what is fact versus interpretation, state what would change the decision, and avoid claiming causal or financial precision that the case does not support.